

Alex Murimi Kariuki
Senior Backend Engineer | Python • Go • Distributed Systems •
Performance Engineering

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Professional Summary

Senior Backend Engineer with 5+ years building and operating event-driven, distributed backend systems for financial, learning, healthcare, and ERP platforms. Production owner of Kubernetes-hosted microservices with hands-on Grafana and Prometheus observability, CI/CD delivery, and on-call incident response. Deep expertise in API and database performance engineering, asynchronous messaging pipelines, and cloud-native architecture on AWS. Polyglot engineer (Python, Go) with strong OOP and distributed-systems fundamentals, currently building proficiency in C#/.NET and the Azure Service Bus ecosystem. Mission-driven, end-to-end owner — from RFCs and architecture through monitoring, optimization, and decommissioning.

Core Technologies & Core Expertise

Python • Go • C#/.NET • Django • Django REST Framework • PostgreSQL • Redis • Celery • AWS • Docker • Linux • REST APIs • Backend Performance Engineering • Distributed Systems • Financial Systems • ERP Integrations • Cloud Architecture • System Design

Savannah Informatics Limited

Senior Backend Engineer

September 2025 - Present

- **Reduced** production database queries from **594 to 6** using advanced Django ORM optimization.
- **Optimized** an organisation-unit workflow from **819 queries to 36**, reducing execution time from **10.6s to 3.2s**.
- **Reduced** API response time for a production payment endpoint from **19 seconds to 220ms** through database optimization and serializer redesign.
- **Designed** backend services supporting healthcare billing, ERP synchronization, payment processing, and financial workflows.
- **Designed** resilient asynchronous processing pipelines using Celery, idempotency controls, retries, and event-driven architecture.
- **Led** backend performance engineering initiatives through profiling, Redis caching, ORM optimization, and database tuning.

- **Contributed** to architecture discussions, RFCs, code reviews, and engineering standards across backend teams.
- **Contributed to production observability end-to-end** — design and maintain Grafana dashboards and Prometheus-based alerts for backend services running on Kubernetes.

Founder & Lead Software Engineer

Getotech Ltd | *Sept 2023 – Present*

- Founded Getotech to build software and IoT solutions for transportation, education, and business automation.
- Architect cloud-native backend platforms and an IoT-powered passenger information system using Python, C#, Django, Redis, Docker, AWS, and ESP32.

Co-Founder & Backend Engineer

A Million Techies | *Nov 2024 – Present*

Co-founded a technology community empowering African software engineers through mentorship, technical writing, backend platform development, and practical learning.

Built and maintained backend platform features supporting community learning, content delivery, and member engagement.

Earlier Experience

Backend Developer & Integrations Engineer — Greenlead Africa (2024)

Freelance Backend & Cloud Engineer (2023 – Present)

Software Engineer Intern → Junior Software Engineer — Machini Technologies (2022 – 2023)

Selected Engineering Projects

Learning Management Platform — Cloud-native LMS built with **Python, Django, React, PostgreSQL, Docker, and AWS** supporting courses, learner progress, and certificates. <https://learn.amilliontechies.com/> and <https://www.studybuddy.africa/>

AI Missing Persons Recognition — Facial recognition platform built with **Python, OpenCV, and PyTorch** for identity matching. <https://github.com/Alekita254/Attendance>

Smart Passenger Information System — IoT platform using **ESP32, AWS, and real-time synchronization** for public transport displays.

Education : B.Sc. Computer Science — Tharaka University

Certifications: AWS Cloud Practitioner • Oracle DevOps • Oracle Vector Search
• Cisco CyberOps Associate • Founders Factory Africa